EXECUTIVE BRIEF

Canadian Crime, 2025

Overall crime eased in 2025 — but only modestly, with some crimes still up

Prepared with AI assistance and reviewed · August 2026

T L ; D R

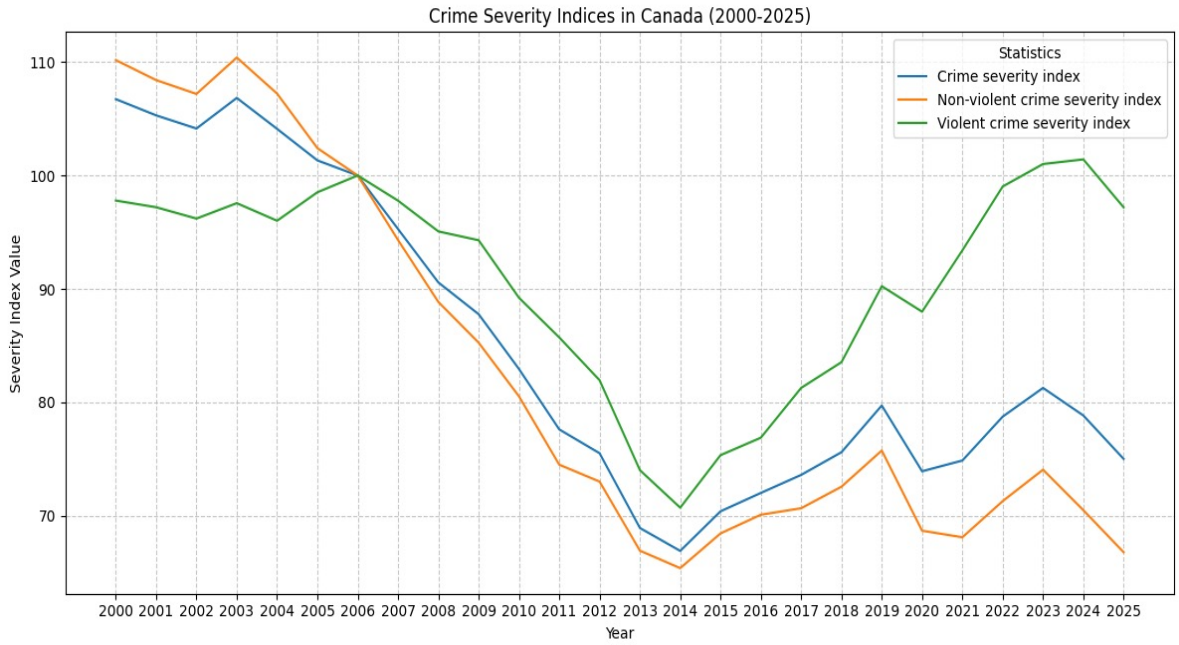
A mixed picture — headlines down, clearance up

–4.86%	–2.4%	+2.35%	–16.5%
Crime Severity Index	**Overall crime rate**	**Weighted clearance rate**	**Homicide rate**
Second straight annual decline.	*Per 100,000 population, vs. 2024.*	*Police solved cases at a higher rate, weighted for severity*	*First-degree murder down 23.7%.*

Overall crime rate and severity went down and police case clearance rate moved up

T H E L O N G V I E W

Crime Severity Index down after a long climb



The 2025 numbers

CSI 75.01 (−4.86%). Non-violent CSI 66.78 (−5.26%). Violent CSI 97.19 (−4.17%).

A modest reversal, not a return

Violent CSI climbed almost every year from 2014 through 2024. 2025's dip walks back only a fraction of that decade-long climb.

Non-violent led the improvement

Non-violent CSI drove most of the 2025 improvement — youth non-violent CSI fell −6.41%.

Statistics Canada, 2000–2025

T H E G O O D N E W S

Improvement across most major categories

01 Violent crime

−16.5% Homicide rate

−23.7% First-degree murder rate

−15.0% Attempted murder rate

Deep declines in some of the most serious offences.

02 Property crime

−16.4% Motor-vehicle theft rate

−10.6% Breaking & entering rate

−3.8% Total property crime rate

Big-ticket property crimes fell sharply.

03 Cyber, organized & hate

2nd yr Cybercrime — second year of decline

1st yr Organized crime — first drop since 2021

−3% Hate crime incidents

All three categories saw declines in 2025 vs. 2024.

Year-over-year change vs. 2024 · rates per 100,000 population

Statistics Canada · July 2026 release

B U T N O T E V E R Y W H E R E

Serious offences that still moved the wrong way

+4.10% — **Arson, disregard for human life**
Rate per 100,000 population

+3.49% — **Sexual assault, level 2 (weapon or bodily harm)**
Aggravated sexual assault categories moved unevenly — level 1 was −1.22%, level 3 was −3.19%, but level 2 climbed.

+16.7% — **Trafficking in stolen property**
The sharpest jump in the property-crime table — even as motor-vehicle theft and B&E fell sharply.

+11.4% — **Shoplifting $5,000 or under**
Now 501.64 per 100,000 — continues to run against the broader property-crime decline.

+2.66% — **Theft over $5,000**
One of the few high-value property categories to rise year over year.

Percentage change in rate per 100,000 population, 2025 vs. 2024

W H Y T H I S M A T T E R S

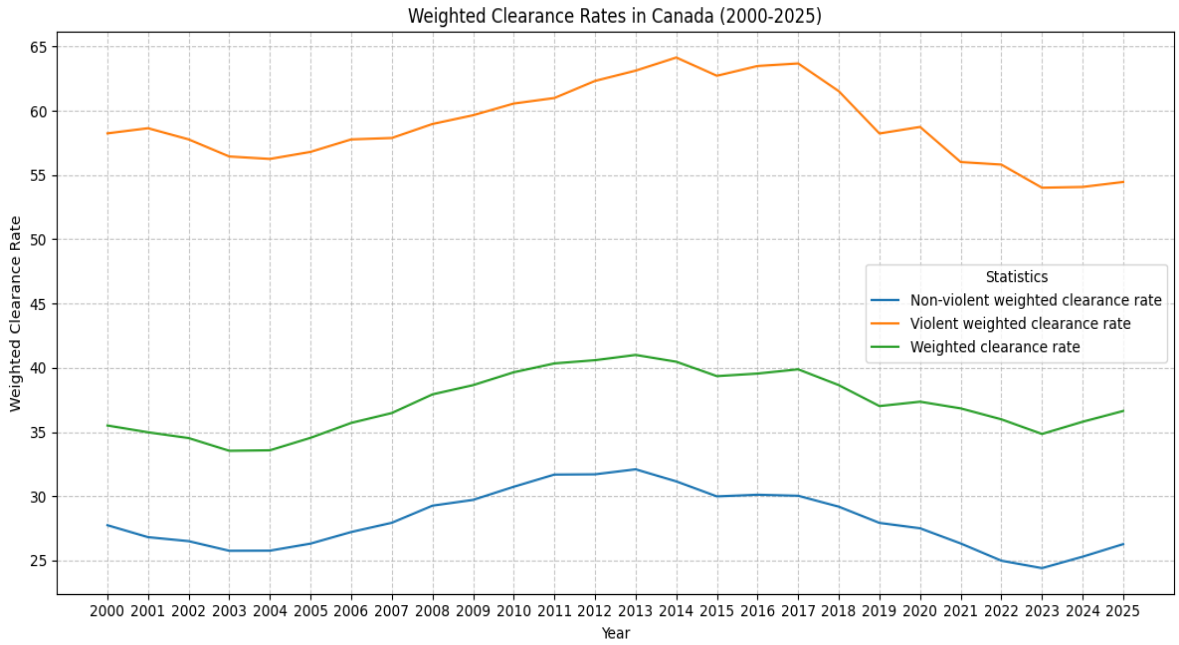
The overall picture is down, but **the headline masks pockets that got worse** — and two of them (arson-with-disregard-for-life and level-2 sexual assault) sit at the serious end of the harm scale.

Year-over-year percentage change in rate, 2025 vs. 2024.

Statistics Canada · July 2026 release

P O L I C E C L E A R A N C E

Clearance rate ticks up for the second year, after decline



The 2025 numbers

Overall weighted clearance rate 36.64% (+2.35%). Violent 54.46%. Non-violent 26.28%.

A reversal, but off a decade-long slide

Clearance rates had trended down for years, especially for violent crime. 2025 is a second uptick.

A start, not a fix

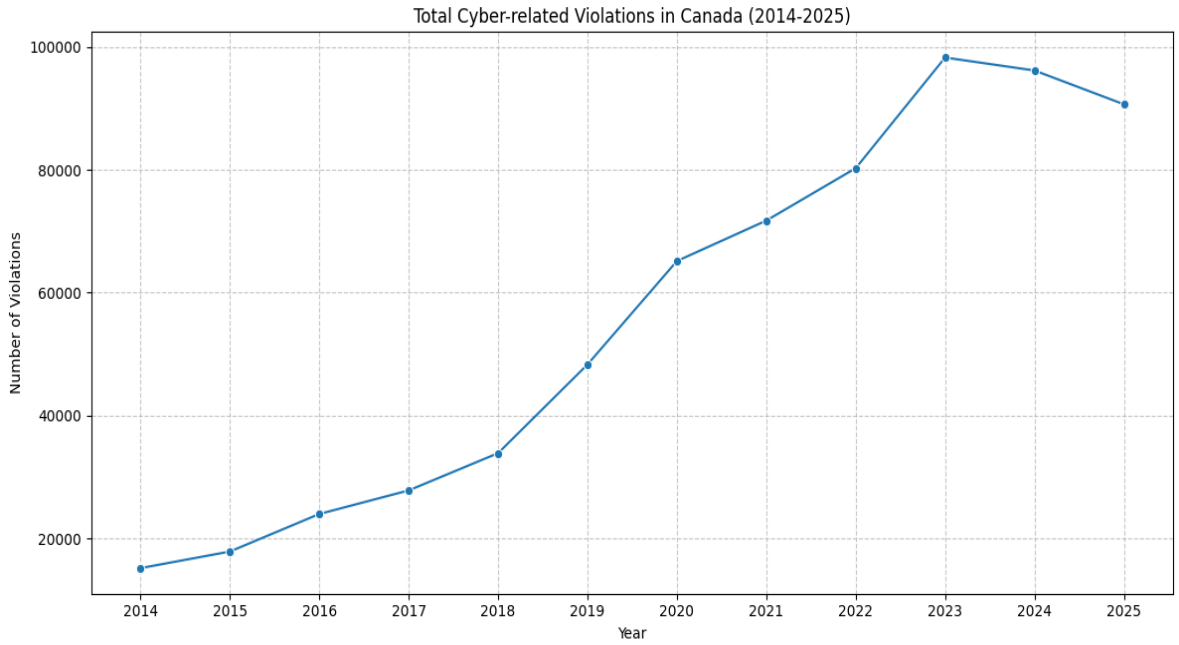
Non-violent weighted clearance rate at ~26%, but still better than 2024

Weighted clearance rate, Canada · StatCan Table 35-10-0026

Statistics Canada · July 2026 release

O N E T O W A T C H

Cybercrime plateaus — a second straight year off the peak



The 2025 number

90,643 cyber-related violations in 2025 — a second straight annual decline from the peak reached in 2023.

But look at the scale

Still ~6× the 2014 baseline. The plateau is high, not low.

Fraud dominates

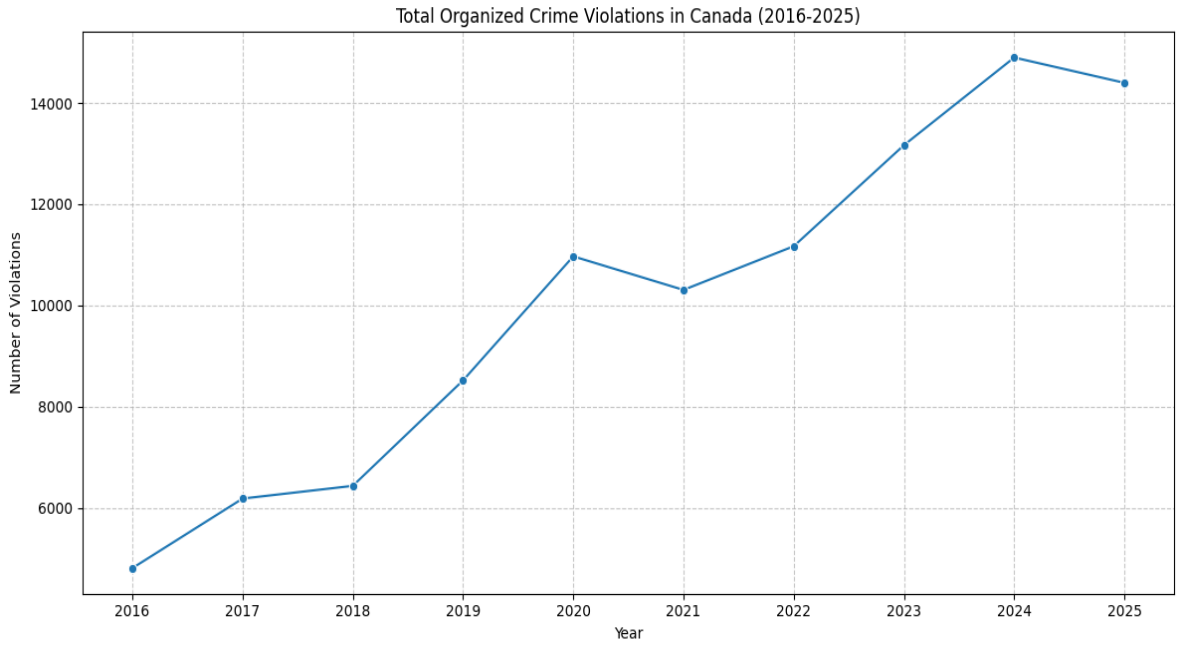
Fraud alone accounts for 44,542 of 2025 cyber violations — nearly half the total.

Canada, selected police services · StatCan Table 35-10-0001

Statistics Canada · July 2026 release

O N E T O W A T C H

Organized crime — 2025 breaks a 5-year climb



The 2025 number

14,398 organized-crime violations in 2025 — the first year-over-year decline since 2021.

Still near the peak

Roughly tripled from 4,810 violations in 2016, so 2025 remains nearly 3× the 2016 level.

Where the volume is

Fraud (6,728) and motor-vehicle theft (1,475) remain the top two organized-crime charges in 2025.

Canada, selected police services

Statistics Canada · July 2026 release